

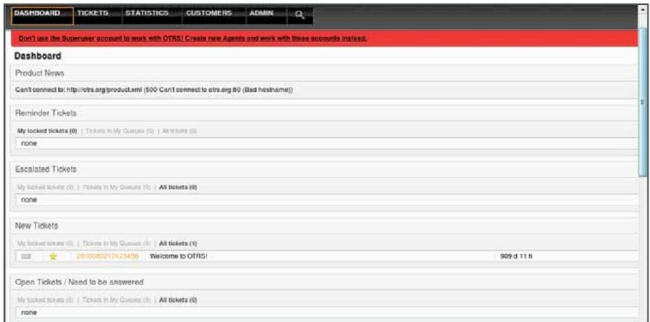


Figure 1: OTRS first screen

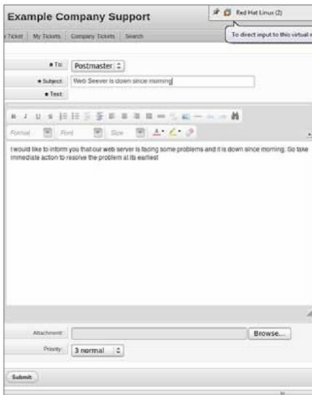


Figure 2: Raising a ticket

```
mysql -u root -p otrs < scripts/database/otrs-schema-post.
mysql.sqlmysql -u root -p -e 'GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON otrs.*
TO otrs@localhost IDENTIFIED BY "otrs" WITH GRANT OPTION;'
mysql -u root -p -e 'FLUSH PRIVILEGES;'
```

Start the OTRS service using the *service otrs start*

command. Also make sure to adjust your firewall and SELinux settings, or turn them off. Next, point your browser to <http://localhost/otrs/index.pl> and you'll get the login screen of OTRS. Log in with the OTRS admin account username *root@localhost* and the default password *root*.

After successfully installing OTRS, it's time to see it working. Let's create a customer and then this 'customer' can raise a ticket. Click the *CUSTOMERS* tab in the home screen, and fill in the necessary details of that customer and submit it. Now point your browser to <http://localhost/otrs/customer.pl> and log in with the newly created customer credentials. I have created a user named *vinayak* and logged in with this account. Once logged in, just click *New Ticket* to raise a ticket. Once you've typed your problem statement, submit it, so that it can be tracked and resolved.

Again log in to the admin account as before, and under the *New Tickets* section, you'll see the ticket the customer had raised. Just click the link to view it. If you click *Lock*, it signifies that this ticket is currently being processed—someone's taking care of it. So here, the cycle of raising a ticket and acknowledging it is complete. Now we can take the necessary actions to resolve this problem.

This was a basic overview of how OTRS can raise and manage trouble tickets. I can't cover all aspects of this cool tool here, so I suggest you visit its website for more. You can also test-drive OTRS at <http://www.otrs.com/en/software/otrs-help-desk/online-demo/>. Keep exploring and wait for my next article! 

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